Core aerator maintenance schedule

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For walk-behind and stand-on core aerators. Tines and drive chains take the beating, so most of the work is daily and every 25 hours. A season of aerating can put a lot of hours on in a few weeks.

Typical intervals from manufacturer manuals and published service schedules. Your machine's manual comes first.

Break-in (new aerators)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
First engine oil change	After 5 hours	Some models change the oil filter too	

Every day

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Check engine oil	Daily		
Tine drive chains: tension, condition, lube	Daily to every 25 hours	Dirty chains need it daily	
Check the tines	Daily	Replace bent or worn ones; never straighten them	
Look for loose fasteners	Daily		
Clean grass and dirt off the machine and engine	Daily		
Test the safety switches	Daily	Stand-on models	

By hours

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Grease tine shaft bearings and idlers	Every 25 to 50 hours		
Belt tension and condition	Every 25 to 50 hours		
Foam pre-cleaner	Every 25 hours on walk-behinds	More often in dust or sand	
Tine reel nut torque	Every 50 hours	Per your manual's torque spec	
Tire pressure, spark arrester	Every 50 hours		
Engine oil	Every 50 to 100 hours		
Oil filter	Every 100 hours		
Hydraulic fluid and filters	Every 100 to 250 hours	Depends on the model	
Fuel filter	Every 250 to 800 hours		
Paper air filter	Every 300 to 500 hours	Sooner in dust	

Yearly or before storage

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Grease caster pivots, hubs and idler pivots	Yearly	Stand-on models	
Re-torque wheel lug and hub nuts	Yearly		
Coat the tines with rust preventive	Before storage		
Lubricate chains and bearings after pressure washing	Every wash		
Check the battery	Monthly in season		

Service log: core aerator

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	HOURS	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS

Free printable from fleetoptima.org/maintenance-schedules